HUMAN RESOURCES & COMPANY POLICIES

Code of Business Conduct & Ethics

Apex Global Technologies Inc. — Professional Conduct, Communication, and Acceptable Use

Effective Date: January 1, 2026 **Version:** 5.0 **Classification:** Confidential — Internal **Owner:** Legal & Compliance

1. Purpose and Scope of Application

The Code of Business Conduct and Ethics sets forth the fundamental values, legal requirements, and professional conduct expectations that govern every director, officer, employee, contractor, and representative of Apex Global Technologies worldwide. We are committed to conducting business with integrity, transparency, and respect for all stakeholders.

2. Inclusive Workplace, Anti-Discrimination, and Harassment Prevention

Apex is committed to fostering a safe, diverse, and inclusive working environment free from unlawful discrimination and harassment:

- **Equal Opportunity:** Employment decisions (hiring, promotion, compensation, termination) are made solely on individual merit, qualifications, and business needs, without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, disability, veteran status, or genetic profile.
- **Harassment-Free Workplace:** We strictly prohibit verbal, physical, sexual, visual, or digital harassment. Bullying, hostile language, offensive jokes, unwelcome advances, and derogatory slurs are subject to immediate termination.
- **Mandatory Reporting:** Any manager or supervisor who receives a complaint or observes behavior violating this policy must immediately report it to People Operations or Legal.

3. Conflicts of Interest, Moonlighting, and Outside Activities

Employees must avoid any relationship, investment, or activity that impairs—or appears to impair—their independent judgment or fidelity to Apex:

- **Secondary Employment (Moonlighting):** Full-time employees may not engage in outside business activities, consulting, or employment that conflicts with their job responsibilities, utilizes company resources, or competes directly or indirectly with Apex's products and services. Any outside engagement requires prior written disclosure and approval from People Operations.
- **Financial Interests:** Employees may not hold significant financial interests in competitors, suppliers, or enterprise clients without written disclosure to the Chief Compliance Officer.
- **Gifts and Entertainment:** Business courtesies (meals, entertainment, branded gifts) may not exceed $50 in nominal value and must never be offered or accepted to influence a business decision or government official (strict compliance with the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act / UK Bribery Act).

4. Professional Communication and Digital Standards

- **Corporate Collaboration Channels:** Slack, Google Workspace, and GitHub are business tools. Communications must remain professional, respectful, and constructive at all times.

- **Public Representation & Media:** Employees are not authorized to speak on behalf of Apex to journalists, news outlets, or media agencies without explicit written authorization from Corporate Communications.
- **Social Media Usage:** When discussing technology, software, or industry topics on personal social channels (LinkedIn, X/Twitter, personal blogs), employees must state clearly: *"The views expressed here are my own and do not necessarily represent the views of Apex Global Technologies."* Never post confidential code, screenshots of internal dashboards, or client names.

5. Acceptable Use of Company Assets and Intellectual Property

- **Asset Integrity:** Laptops, monitors, networks, and software licenses are provided for business operations. Incidental personal use is permissible provided it does not interfere with productivity, violate security policies, or consume excessive network resources.
- **Software Licensing:** Pirated, unverified, or unauthorized third-party software may not be installed on corporate hardware. All open-source packages must comply with the approved Open Source License Whitelist (Apache 2.0, MIT, BSD; AGPL/GPLv3 require legal review).
- **Proprietary Information:** Employees must safeguard trade secrets, architecture schemas, customer datasets, and pricing models. Obligations to protect proprietary information survive termination of employment.

6. Whistleblower Protection and Non-Retaliation Policy

> **Zero Tolerance for Retaliation**
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> Apex strictly forbids retaliation against any employee who in good faith reports suspected misconduct, policy violations, or legal non-compliance. Any individual found engaging in retaliatory behavior will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including immediate termination.
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> **Confidential Reporting Hotline:** Phone: 1-800-ETHIC-APEX | Web: https://ethics.internal.apextech.com | Email: compliance@apextech.internal